



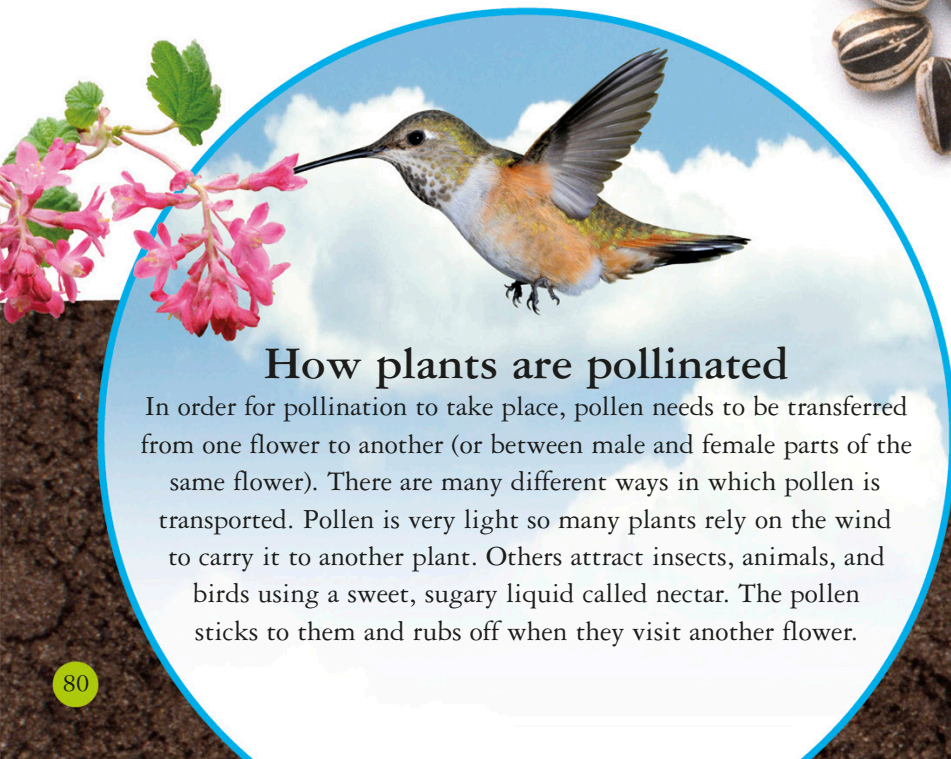
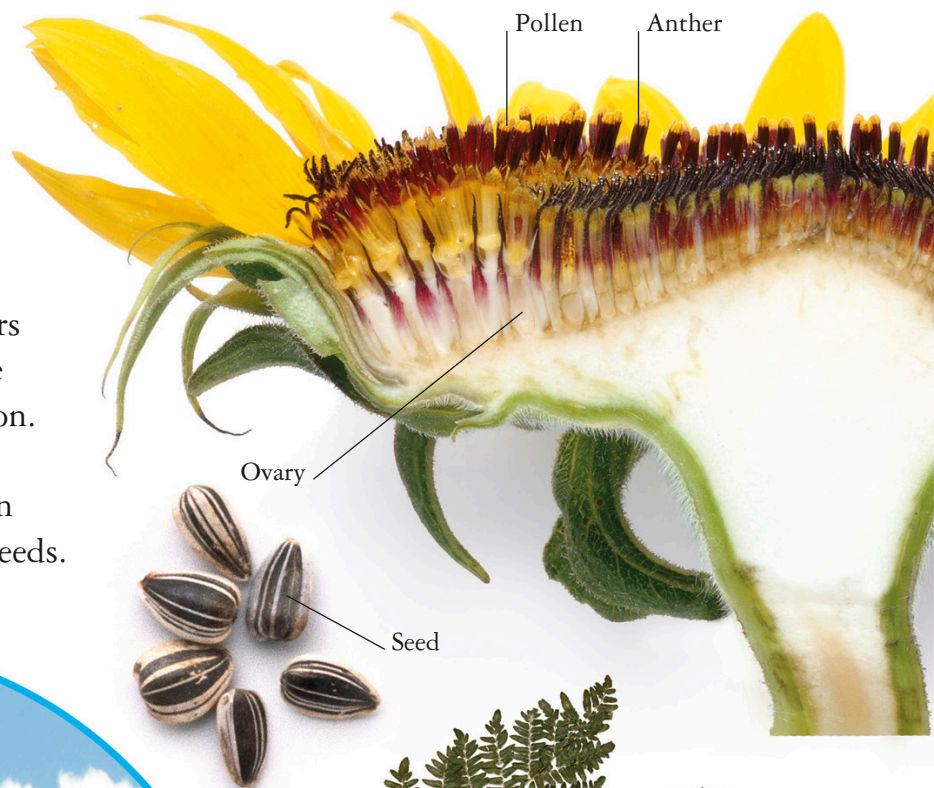
Scattering the SEED

Plants can't move around to find a mate or more room to grow, so they have evolved ingenious ways to make new plants and spread themselves around. Some produce mini versions of themselves that stay close to the original plant. Others make seeds that can be carried by wind, water, or animals and dispersed over a wide area.

INSIDE A FLOWER

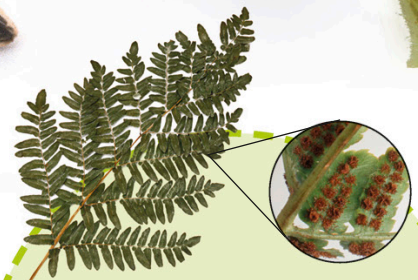
Most flowering plants reproduce by producing seeds. The flower contains the reproductive organs, which include the stigma, ovary, and anthers. The anthers contain pollen, which is transferred to the stigma of another flower during pollination. Cells from the pollen travel down to the ovary, which contains the eggs. The pollen fertilizes the eggs and they develop into seeds.

INSIDE A
SUNFLOWER



How plants are pollinated

In order for pollination to take place, pollen needs to be transferred from one flower to another (or between male and female parts of the same flower). There are many different ways in which pollen is transported. Pollen is very light so many plants rely on the wind to carry it to another plant. Others attract insects, animals, and birds using a sweet, sugary liquid called nectar. The pollen sticks to them and rubs off when they visit another flower.



Spreading spores

Plants that don't have flowers, such as mosses, ferns, and worts, reproduce using spores. Unlike seeds, spores don't have much food stored so they are only released when conditions are right for a quick germination. Large numbers of spores are produced in the hope that a few will survive.